Yongjian Groenendijk-Li, PhD

Interdisciplinary social scientist | Rotterdam, Netherlands | ORCID: 0000-0001-8645-2531

Research across ageing, migration, care, social belonging and technological change. Ethnographic, narrative and participatory approaches to understanding people's agency and the social and institutional conditions shaping access and participation.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Researcher | Eindhoven University of Technology | Apr 2026-present

Built Environment research across ageing and care, environmental psychology and technology. ELLI and MOVUS: frameworks and field research instruments on accessibility, agency, participation and person-environment fit; Living Lab approaches and technology use or non-use in care settings.

Lecturer | Erasmus University Rotterdam | Sep 2023-Nov 2025

Taught BA, pre-master's and MA students in academic skills, research methods, intercultural communication, communication and social impacts, and media industries and audiences. Supervised over 20 internships; second reader for BA/MA theses. PCMC Teaching Award 2025; average evaluations around 4.8/5; RISBO university didactics training.

Doctoral Researcher | Erasmus University Rotterdam | Sep 2019-Sep 2025

Qualitative research on older Houniao migrants, digital place-making and belonging, using interviews, participant observation, digital ethnography and narrative, thematic and framing analysis. PhD defended 25 September 2025.

Visiting / Affiliated Researcher | University of Helsinki | Sep 2017-May 2019

Comparative research on social justice, educational policy and institutional practice in China and Finland; academic publishing, editing and co-authoring a monograph on teachers' continuing professional development.

GGZ Nurse Trainee | Antes | Sep-Nov 2025

Worked alongside multidisciplinary staff supporting people with intersecting mental health, addiction and housing-related needs, providing first-hand exposure to care practice and service access.

EDUCATION

PhD, Media and Communication | Erasmus University Rotterdam | 2025
Research MA, Public Policy | Renmin University of China | 2018
BA, Public Administration | Wuhan University | 2016
Doctoral studies, School, Education, Society & Culture | University of Helsinki | 2018-2019

RESEARCH FUNDING

Memory as Care | Convergence Resilient Delta Initiative Kick-Starter | 2026-2027 | EUR 35,000 project award. Co-applicant; participatory oral-history research design and collaboration with universities and Rotterdam community partners. Planned memory cafes, interviews and public exhibition.

TEACHING AND METHODOLOGY

Teaching: research design, qualitative methods, academic skills, writing and methodological reflection; intercultural communication, communication and social impacts, media industries and audiences; internships and assessment.

Research methods: ethnography, interviewing, participant observation, digital ethnography, narrative inquiry, oral history, photo-elicitation, thematic and critical framing analysis, research ethics and data management planning.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES (9)

1. Li, Y., & Krijnen, T. (2026). Care recipients, active agers, or lifestyle seekers? Media Asia, 53(4), 1097-1118.

2. Li, Y., & Krijnen, T. (2026). Vlogging my lives of two homes: Chinese Houniao and place-making in the online-offline nexus. Mobile Media & Communication, 14(1), 211-229.

3. Li, Y. (2025). Vlogging as mediated mobility: Warm Experts 3.0 engaging in peer production and digital labor. International Journal of Cultural Studies, 28(3), 562-579.

4. Quan, J., Li, Y., Zhang, M., & Wu, Z. (2025). Gain or Pain: The Double-Edged Sword Effect of Artificial Intelligence Adoption on Employee Service Performance. Journal of Organizational Behavior.

5. Quan, J., Yang, Y., Wu, Z., & Li, Y. (2025). Empowered to excel: How and when customer empowering behaviors ignite employee customer-oriented citizenship behaviors. Journal of Hospitality Marketing & Management, 34(5), 704-724.

6. Li, Y., & Alencar, A. P. (2023). A tale of two cities: Digital place-making and elderly Houniao migration in China. Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies, 49(4), 1032-1049.

7. He, G., Leurs, K., & Li, Y. (2022). Researching motherhood in the age of short videos: Stay-at-home mothers in China performing labor on Douyin. Media and Communication, 10(3), 273-289.

8. Li, Y., & Dervin, F. (2018). Comparing and contrasting how social justice is done in education? Education and Society, 36(1), 35-54.

9. Li, Y., & Dervin, F. (2018). Interculturality in a different light: Modesty towards democracy in education? Intercultural Communication Education, 1(1), 12-26.

BOOK AND REFERENCE WORK

Li, Y., & Dervin, F. (2018). Continuing Professional Development of Teachers in Finland. Palgrave Macmillan.

Li, Y., & Dervin, F. (2019). Constructions of social justice, marginalization, and belonging. Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Education.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Special issues co-editor, International Journal of Bias, Identity and Diversities in Education (2018-2019); NeFCA Young Scholars Network board member (2023-2024); peer review across media, migration and urban research; panel chair at 2026 SHE World Conference; public expert interview in WIRED (2023).

LANGUAGES AND ELIGIBILITY

English: academic working language. Dutch: B2 self-assessment; formal B2 exam scheduled November 2026. Dutch citizen.

Full publications, DOI links and activities: https://yjgroenendijk.github.io/publications/ and /activities/